

HOW TO GIVE A BEDBATH AND WASH

Washing can be tiresome and painful for someone who is frail and ill. Ensure that you discuss bedbathing with the person you care for and decide on when he or she feels up to it and what time of day is best. Also find out what he or she wants to wash alone. For someone who has to spend long periods of time in bed, washing that person's hands and face regularly is very refreshing.

To wash someone in bed, you need:

- A bowl of warm water
- Towels and flannels
- Soap.



Make sure that you will not be disturbed and that the room is warm and draft free. Place a towel beneath the person you are going to bedbath.

Help with undressing and leave him or her covered with a top sheet for warmth. Wash and dry every part of the body in turn (first the face, then the chest, etc.). Keep to the following routine:

- Face
- Chest
- Arms
- Under Arms
- Back.

Your client may wish to wear deodorant and this is a good time for it to be put on.

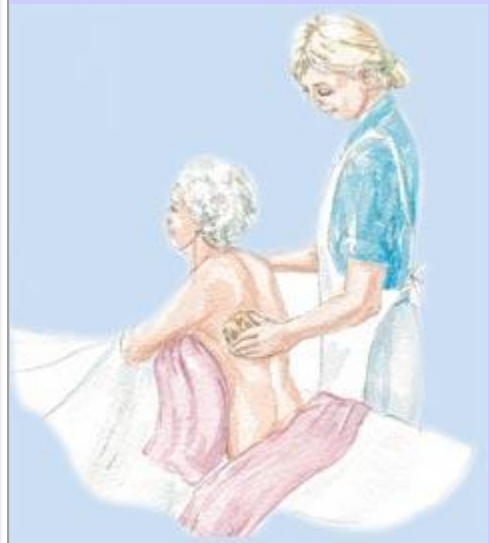


Then you may wish to dress the upper part of the body to ensure warmth and dignity.

- Legs
- Lower body and groin.

Change the water. You can then roll the person on to their side to wash: You should also be using a different flannel from the one used for the face and upper body area.

- Lower back
- Behind the legs
- Feet & between Toes
- Lower Personal Area
- Groin
- Buttocks ensuring that you wash properly between the buttocks to avoid soreness and infection.



You must always ensure that you dry the client properly on all areas of the skin, in folds and every crevice. This is to ensure that the client does not become sore which can lead to infection.

Every Bedbath or wash should include the feet and between the toes as this can, if left dirty, can cause irritation and infection. If the client is bed bound then their feet are on show and they do not wish people to see them with dirty feet.